

Global Environmental Politics

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Last class: climate change and firms

- Market competition can be insufficient.
- Firms support environmental regulation if it is good business.
 - Can avoid via greenwashing.
 - Self-regulate to prevent further regulation.
 - If it affects the competition, providing an edge.
- Double representation can reduce policy adjustment.
- Timing and cost of policies determine implementation.

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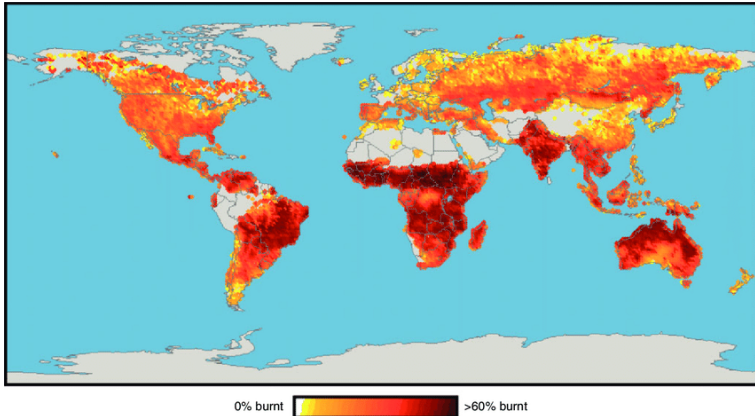
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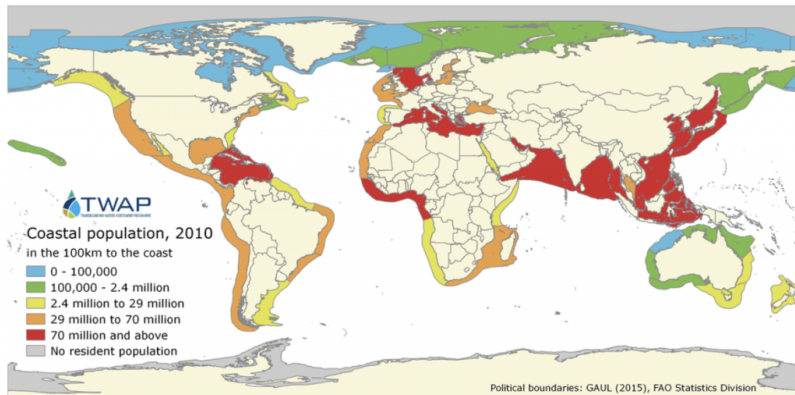
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Climate migration/displacement will be widespread



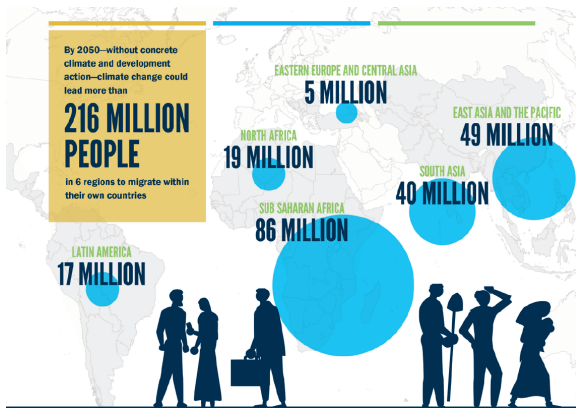
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- 143 mill. climate migrants by 2050.
- Different patterns but same story: pressure on resources.
- Not a problem that is too far away.

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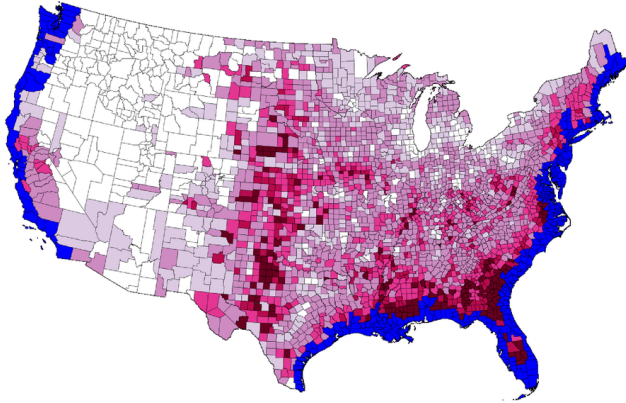
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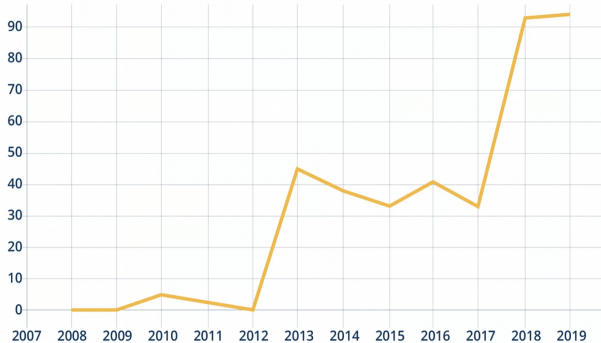
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NUMBER OF WEATHER-RELATED EVENTS IN EUROPE THAT CAUSED DISPLACEMENT

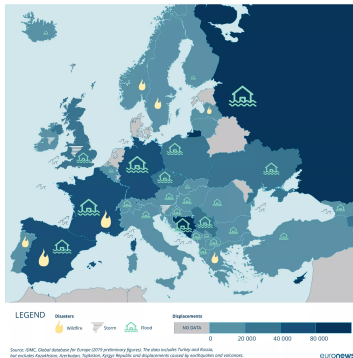


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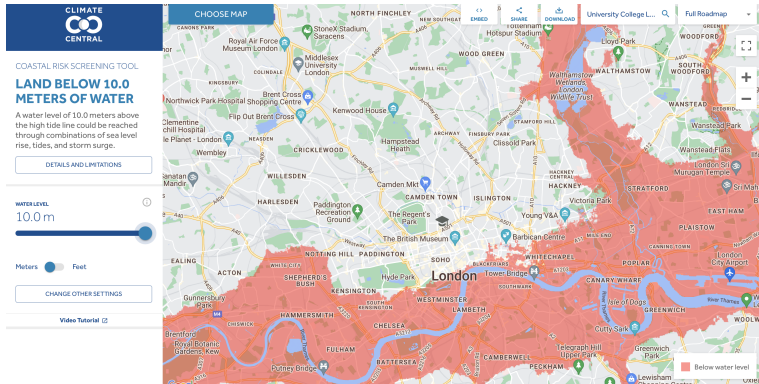
DISPLACEMENT IN EUROPE BY WEATHER EVENT (2008-2019)

Icons represent the most common cause of displacement for each country



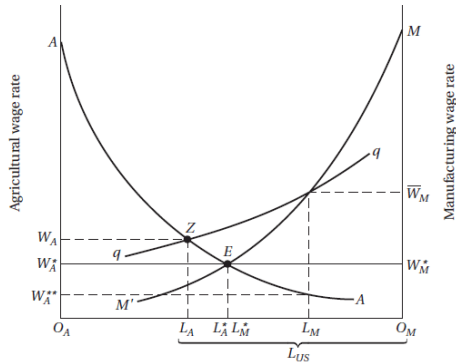
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The decision to migrate

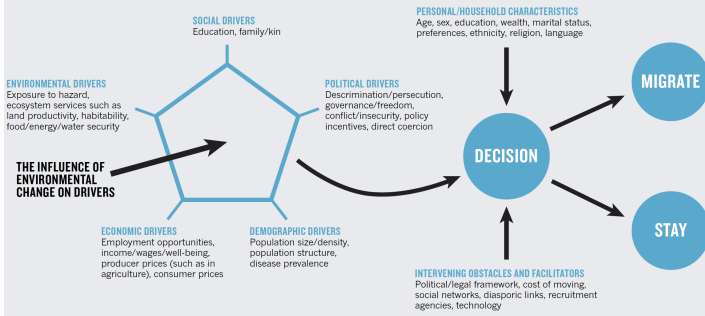


- Migration until marginal benefit = marginal cost.
 - Urban wages = rural areas if no frictions.
- Frictions imply return urban area > return rural area.
 - Transportation costs; housing; local adaptation; Pr(obtain job).
- Same implications for international migration.
- Is forced displacement citizens' fault?

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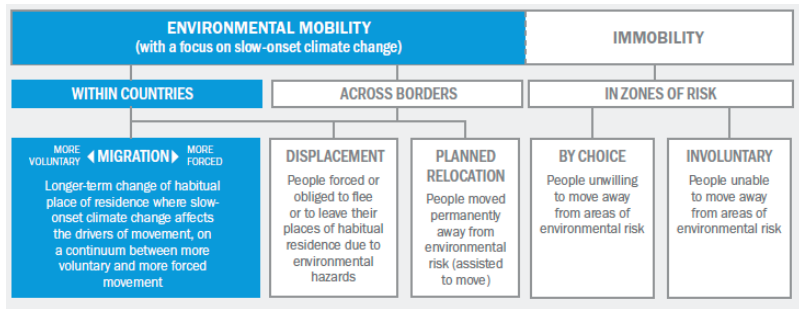
THE DRIVERS OF MIGRATION

Many factors influence whether a person or family will migrate. Their effects are closely intertwined, so it makes little sense to consider any of them in isolation.



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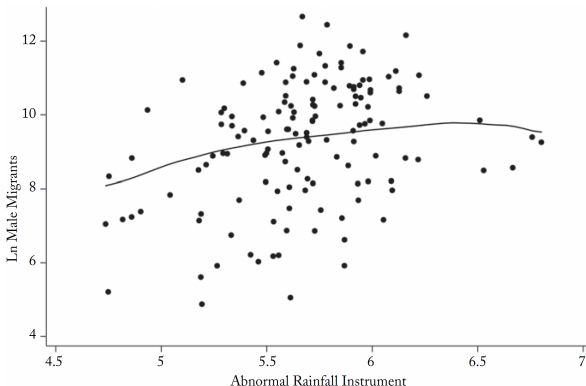
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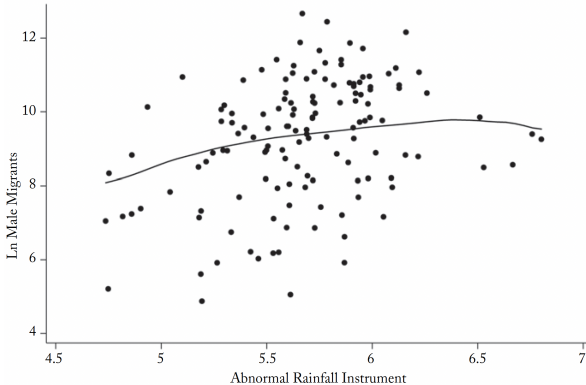
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Climate change impact decision to migrate



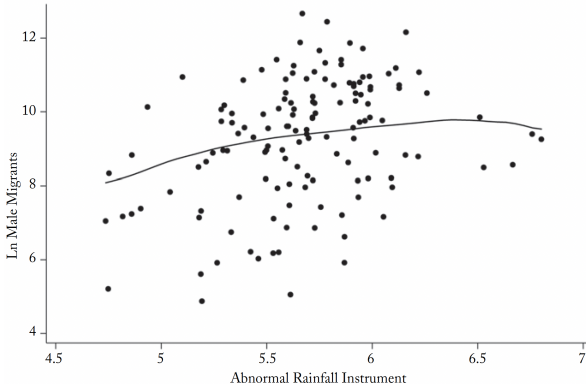
- $\downarrow$ fixed costs $\Rightarrow$ $\downarrow$ opp. cost of migrating.
- Facilitated by the existence of diasporas and big labor markets.
- Vulnerability trap for the poorest citizens.
- Uninformed about risk of attempted migration.

Climate change impact decision to migrate



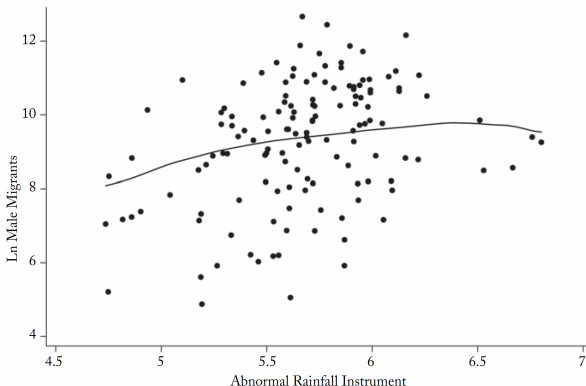
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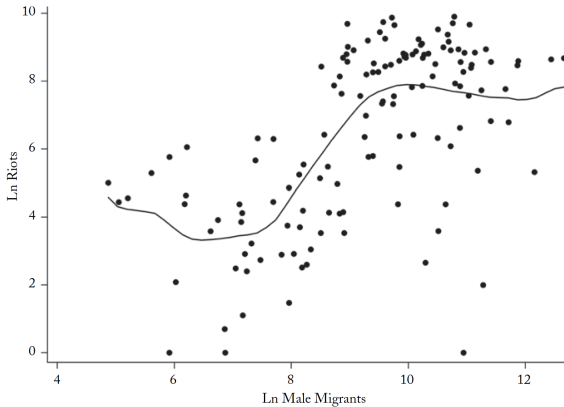
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Backlash against migrants

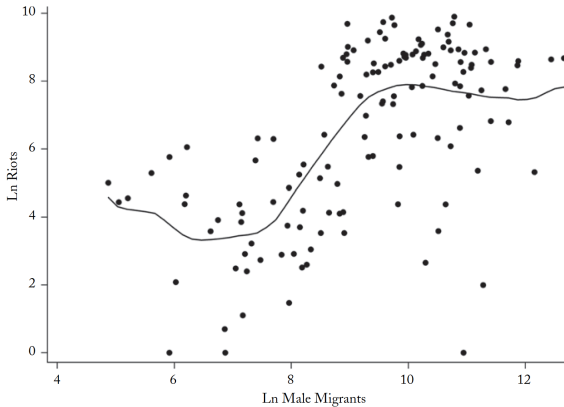


■ $\uparrow$ resources $\Rightarrow$ Scarcity $\Rightarrow$ $\uparrow$ conflict.

■ Locals may treat migrants as outsiders, even if from same country.

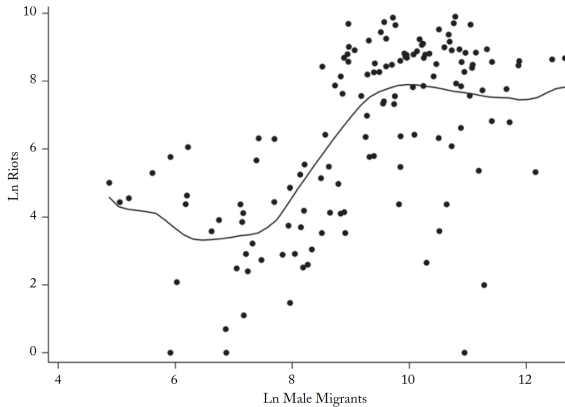
■ Pie is the same size but there are more “mouths” to feed.

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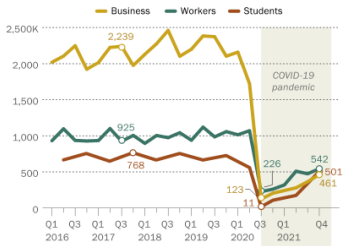


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Pathways for international migration

U.S. arrivals of temporary migrants, especially business travelers, are below pre-pandemic levels

Arrivals of temporary business, worker and student migrants, in thousands

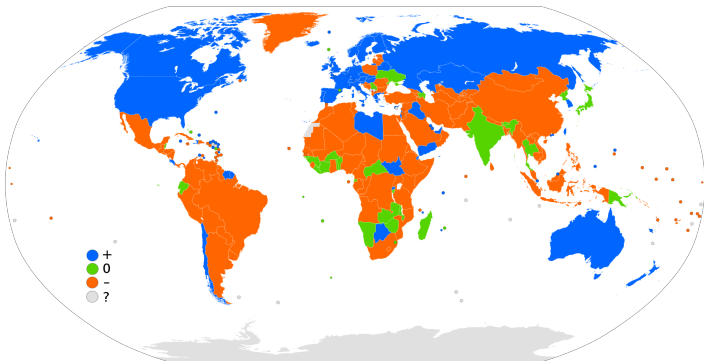


Notes: Data labels shown for April-June 2017, April-June 2020 and July-September 2021, except for the "Students" plot, its 2017 data label is for July-September. Due to seasonal variation, student arrivals shown only for January-March and July-September, except April-June 2020. Years shown are fiscal years, which run Oct. 1-Sept. 30 of designated year. Source: Pew Research Center analysis of U.S. Department of Homeland Security Office of Immigration Statistics data.

PEW RESEARCH CENTER

- Legal recognition by the host country via job program or similar.
 - Permanent or circular.
- Refugee status even if climate migrant.
- Illegal border crossing—with all perils it entails.

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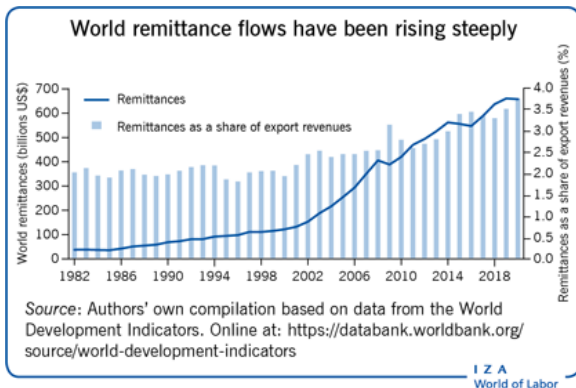
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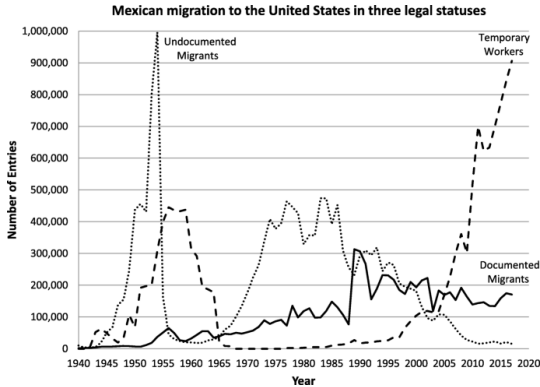
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Remittances and circular migration



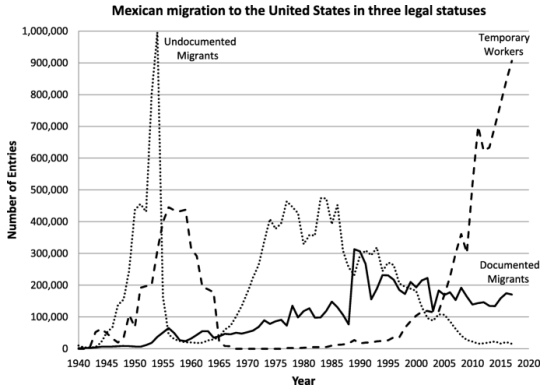
- Temporary or permanent work in scarce industries.
 - Agriculture and other low-skilled manual work.
 - Central America; the Small Island States; Southeast Asia.
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Remittances and circular migration

Figure 6.1: Strategic entry points for action along the life cycle of climate-related mobility

BEFORE MIGRATION

- Invest in better knowledge, anticipation and monitoring
- Foster emissions mitigation and inclusive development
- Embed climate migration in policies and national bodies
- Facilitate adaptation in place
- Enable adaptive mobility



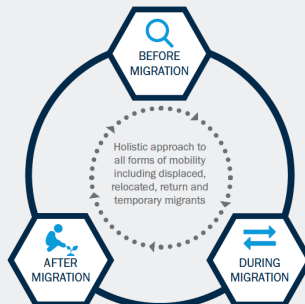
DURING MIGRATION

Support people on the move (holistic approach to all of those migrating, displaced, relocated)



AFTER MIGRATION

Prepare, support, and connect sending and receiving areas and their people—especially in hotspots



Source: Adapted and expanded from Martin (2009).

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Hardening borders



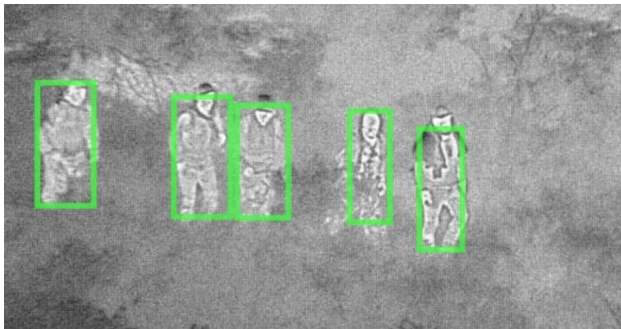
- Migration creates incentives for states to harden borders.
 - Threat multiplier.
- New technology (e.g., AI) has made it easier/less costly.
- Would-be migrants may be trapped in vulnerability.
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Compact agreement on climate migration

Finding	Characteristics/implications	Strength* of evidence
Migration is a key component of sustainable livelihoods and household adaptive capacity in low and middle income countries	Migration is one of many possible ways in which households adapt to and cope with climatic and nonclimatic risks/uncertainty. In countries with weak institutions, migration may be the only form of adaptation available. Households that lack migration options are inherently more vulnerable and less adaptable to the impacts of climatic variability and change.	Broad base of evidence from wide range of empirical studies in multiple regions
Reliance on migration to meet rural livelihood needs is growing	Growing reliance on migration is a common trend across less developed countries. Seasonal migration is common in regions with highly seasonal climates. Migration for longer durations is becoming increasingly common. Most migrants are young adults.	Broad base of evidence from wide range of empirical studies in multiple regions
Most climate-related migration takes place across short distances within countries or across contiguous borders	Local migration has relatively low costs. The destination may be urban or rural, depending on wage-earning opportunities.	Broad base of evidence from wide range of empirical studies in multiple regions

■ Why do we need a global compact on climate migration?

■ Goals of UN Global Compact:

- Reduce climate-related migration and displacement.
- Increase adaptive capacity and resilience.
- Humanitarian international cooperation.

■ Few nations giving legal recognition/opportunities.

Compact agreement on climate migration

Finding	Characteristics/implications	Strength* of evidence
Households that receive remittances from migrants have greater long-term social and economic prospects	Remittances from international migrants are typically of greater value than remittances received from internal migrants. Within communities, remittances increase socioeconomic inequality. Remittances can help improve prospects for disaster recovery and to some extent for preparedness and adaptation, but the overall contribution to building climate resiliency is uncertain.	Broad base of evidence from wide range of empirical studies in multiple regions
Rural to urban migration rates are high and growing	Rural to urban migration rates are growing especially rapidly in Sub-Saharan Africa, although that region is less urbanized than others.	Conclusive statistical evidence
Households that participate in rural to urban resource-sharing networks have greater food security	Such networks are likely to grow in importance as impacts of climate change on food production systems strengthen. Households lacking access to such networks are more vulnerable.	Strong empirical evidence from Sub-Saharan Africa and South America
Migration is a key means of recovering from extreme weather events, including floods and droughts	After an extreme event, households send young adults to seek wage labor opportunities to rebuild lost/damaged housing and livelihood assets. The duration and destination of migration vary by context.	Strong empirical evidence from Central America, East Africa, and South and Southeast Asia

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People in remote areas have worse migration opportunities and adaptation prospects	Remoteness and isolation are important factors in the vulnerability of mountain populations and some dryland areas. People living in areas with good access to roads, markets, and social infrastructure have a greater range of adaptation options and potential migration destinations.	Strong empirical evidence from dryland areas of Africa, the Andes, and Nepal
Gender dimensions can change over time, but have important implications for climate migration	Where only men migrate, women, children, people with disabilities, and the elderly left behind are at greater risk of food insecurity and personal safety. Land degradation and climatic variability can force higher levels of gendered migration or longer-duration migration. Gender dimensions can change over time.	Case study evidence from Bangladesh, Nepal, and Pakistan; more research needed in other countries and regions
Empirical research shows persuasively that climate resilience must be built urgently given the known risks, but there remains uncertainty about which strategies hold the greatest promise and how to implement them	The impacts of extreme heat, dryness, and variability in precipitation on regional migration patterns will grow through 2050 but can be moderated by sound development strategies. Climate impacts on food systems, water resources, and livelihoods accelerate in nonlinear fashion after 2050, as will the risks of large-scale displacements and distress migration. Business as usual will fall far short of meeting future adaptation needs.	Climate model evidence increasingly strong Models of future crop yields vary but decline for several crops Systems understandings of general climate-migration dynamics are increasingly strong, with strong agreement across the research literature Further empirical research on resilience-building needed across most regions

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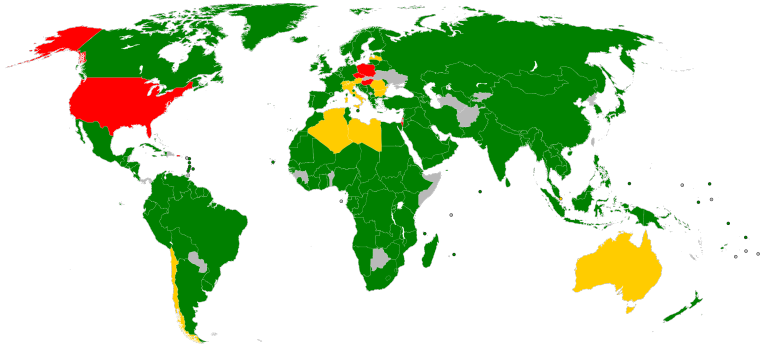
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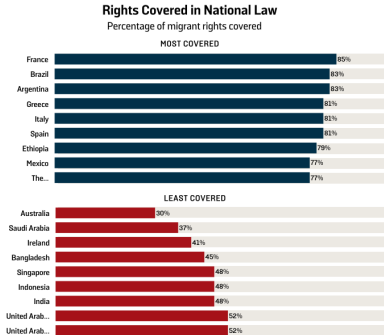
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SOURCE: MIGRANT RIGHTS INITIATIVE

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Class exercise: Can we address climate migration growing the pie?

- 1 Make groups of 2/3 people.
- 2 How can we grown the pie to reduce pressure on resources?
- 3 If we grow the pie, is the possibility of sharing it incentive compatible?
- 4 Worst-case scenario: How can we address negative out-group sentiment?
- 5 10 minutes.
 - Feel free to use the Internet.



reset